

slower than when in Windows. You should strip all file attributes before running the delete command, since hidden and system files will not be deleted from the Command Prompt. Also, using the **deltree** command instead of **del** will ensure that even folders are deleted. Thus, your batch file should contain the following commands:

```
attrib -a -s -r -h c:\Windows\
Temp\*.* /s
Deltree /y C:\Windows\
Temp\*
```

Managing power

Power Management is a very useful feature for notebooks, but not as critical on a desktop PC. With default power management settings, the computer will automatically reduce the spinning rate of the hard disks and blank off the monitor after a few minutes of idle time. In older systems, this sometimes causes Windows to lock up. Depending on the settings, every time you need to use the PC, the hard disk will have to spin up again before data can be accessed on it. Turning off power management completely will not harm the system in any way. At most,



Turn off power saving features

set only the monitor to be turned off. Open **Control Panel > Power Management** and choose Always On under Power schemes to disable all power saving features. Optionally, you can set only the system standby and hard disk settings to Never.

Disable Autorun

Autorun was an innovative feature to automatically launch programs from CD-ROM and DVD drives. However, the way it works, it affects system performance, apart from being irritating at times. While this feature is on, Windows polls the drive every 5 seconds to check if some media has been inserted. If it finds a new disc, it will check it for the autorun.inf file and execute the commands within this. This is quite an overhead, especially when you need the feature only sometimes. This is true for all versions of Windows. To turn it off, open **Control Panel > System > Device Manager**. Expand the CDROM tree, select the drive and click Properties. Under the Settings tab, disable 'Auto insert notification'.

Boot faster

Before Windows loads, it processes certain files to set the correct environment and load initial drivers and Windows settings. The config.sys typically loads drivers and the autoexec.bat sets the environment and runs programs before Windows loads. If these files are loading any unnecessary items, you

BIOS Tweaks

Changing certain BIOS settings can reduce the amount of time it takes to hand over control to the operating system, thereby reducing the time taken to boot. Although there are several different BIOSes with varying options, there are some settings common to all. Look around your BIOS to find these options. Usually, to enter the BIOS setup, you have to press the [Delete] key while it is loading.

Configure your hard drives in the BIOS, instead of setting it to automatically detect them every time it boots. For most

BIOSes, you can simply select the Auto Detect Hard Disks option. Disable Boot Up Floppy Seek. This option checks if there is a floppy in the drive. You also don't need the Virus Protection feature. Enabling this from the BIOS often causes problems with system updates and also slows down the booting time. Change the boot order so that it loads the operating system from the hard drive first. You would hardly ever boot from a floppy or CD-ROM and when you need to, you can switch to this configuration in the BIOS.

should remove them. Both files can be edited in Notepad.

A third file, the msdos.sys, sets several parameters for Windows. It specifies the Windows folder, the location of the startup files, behaviour of the boot menu, etc. Changing a few parameters can ensure faster booting of the operating system. If any parameters exist, you can change its value, or simply add a line with the parameter. Before you can edit this file, however, you must strip its read-only and hidden attributes. To do this, open a Command Prompt window and type this command:

```
attrib -h -r msdos.sys
```

When Windows is not shut down properly, it automatically runs Scandisk when it boots again. You can disable this by using AutoScan=0. Setting its value

to 1 will bring up a prompt asking if you want to run Scandisk and setting it to 2 will run Scandisk automatically. **BootDelay=x** sets the amount of time you have to press [F8] to bring up the boot menu. The default value for this is 2 seconds. If BootMenu is set to 1, it will always bring up the boot menu, **BootMenuDelay** sets the number of seconds this menu is displayed for, before booting with the default selection. When BootWarn is set to 0, Windows will boot to Safe Mode without warning, whenever it does not start properly.

By now, you probably have FAT32 on all drives, so disk compression utilities will not work. You should disable the driver for this by setting DblSpace and DrvSpace to 0. Also, if you do not have a SCSI controller, set